

Corey McCarty

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Staff / Principal Software Engineer

Critical Systems Ownership | Distributed Data Infrastructure | Legacy Modernization

Twelve years owning critical production systems, usually as the person a platform can't run without. I hold a whole system in my head and find where a change has to land before it breaks something three steps away. Deep in distributed data infrastructure, AWS, and legacy modernization. I stay close to the code while setting technical direction and growing the engineers around me.

Core Competencies

Distributed Systems | AWS Operations | Software Architecture | Platform Engineering | Event-Driven Architecture | Legacy Modernization | Production Reliability | Technical Mentorship

Technical Skills

Languages	Java / Spring Boot, JavaScript (Vue, Nuxt, Node), TypeScript, Python, SQL, Bash, Groovy
Cloud & Infra	AWS (Lambda, SQS, Aurora/RDS, Elastic Beanstalk, API Gateway, EC2, CloudWatch), Docker, Jenkins
Databases	Aurora MySQL, Oracle, SQL Server, Cassandra, Rocket UniVerse (Pick)
Practices	Event-driven (SQS/Lambda, JMS), REST, GraphQL, CI/CD, code-review ownership, AI-assisted development (Claude, JetBrains AI Assistant)

Professional Experience

SUMMIT PROFESSIONAL EDUCATION, Remote

Dec 2021 – 2026

Lead Developer (Staff Engineer / Engineering Lead scope)

Senior-most engineer and technical owner for a platform serving 528K accounts and 3.5M+ enrollments.

- Cut a customer-facing B2B account page from ~10 minutes to under a minute with a relation-table redesign; the sales team had refused to demo it and now uses it live to close contracts.
- Set direction for the migration off a legacy Universe/Pick data-entry system, pulled a floundering offshore team off the work, and coached the engineer who shipped the first module on a new Vue 3 frontend writing directly to Aurora.
- Turned myself from the team's bottleneck into its safety net: handed off clean problem definitions so three of five engineers run their own domains, the website, the Yeti platform, and the deployment pipelines, end to end, while I own every code review and pull request.
- Turned a CTO-built SDLC prototype into a structured, on-demand skill system the dev team uses with their AI assistants, adding per-developer profiles, a PR-review workflow, and an app-wiring map of how the repositories connect, so cross-system knowledge lives in the repo, not just in my head.
- Coached an engineer through a nine-month Vue 2 to Vue 3 migration by asking the right questions and letting him make the architectural calls, including adopting ShadCN so the team owns its component library long-term.
- Recovered organic search from ~30th to a consistent top 10 after a disruptive top-down SSR rollout, clearing roughly 300 server errors and 600+ Core Web Vitals issues.
- Rescued a board-mandated CMS migration left without a plan when its owner departed, shipping static HubSpot pages alongside the existing Nuxt application with no visible seam to users.
- Maintain 140+ Lambda functions across the auth path and core business workflows on Elastic Beanstalk and Docker; led the AL2 to AL2023 migration with a clean-environment strategy.
- Delivered a JSP-to-Vue website rebuild a prior contractor had never actually started, with the team learning Vue from scratch and shipping the reframed site under heavy time pressure.
- Run weekly backlog grooming with product, marketing, sales, and customer service to set engineering priorities, increasingly steering the team toward cross-team project work.
- Built reusable Python tooling to run multi-year price increases across the billing platform and the database, updating coupon values and renewal pricing and reapplying offers before renewal reminders.

JUICE PLUS, Memphis, TN

Jun 2020 – Dec 2021

Software Engineer

- Took sole ownership of an undocumented, business-critical Java ETL and reverse-engineered it from the code to become the team's subject-matter expert.
- Prototyped a bridging API unifying five disparate databases behind a single business-entity interface (Hapi, TypeScript, Prisma), learning the full stack from scratch to build it.
- Evaluated Go for the next-generation platform and recommended against adoption despite its technical fit, citing the org-wide rollover cost for an all-Java team.
- Worked alongside the company's most tenured engineers on next-generation architecture and OpenAPI design after an incoming director routed proof-of-concept work my way.

ATOS / SYNTEL (client: FedEx), Memphis, TN

Sep 2014 – May 2020

Software Engineer

- Owned and operated a Tier 1 XML document platform (~60TB) across two data centers, holding flight records and the auth data other systems depended on; carried 24/7/365 on-call alone for four years.
- Resolved most off-hours incidents by tracing faults to their real source, often proving the problem lived in a client system rather than ours.
- Built the runtime-configurable data layer behind an internal InfoSec risk-scoring system, a field model returning confidence scores on signals like IP, location, and domain.

Community & Talks

- Code Connector (volunteer): co-designed and run The Coding Dojo, a guided mob-programming meetup for newer developers; maintain the shared solutions repo and led a Hacktoberfest push. Several participants credit the Dojo with the confidence that landed their first developer jobs.
- Talk: "A Rising Tide Lifts All Boats," GitKon. Byline: GitKraken Blog, "How to Nail Your First Full-Time Job Interview."

Education

B.S. Computer Engineering · University of Memphis · 2013